



free will
and
determinism

A large, solid orange circle with a subtle drop shadow, centered on a white background. Inside the circle, the text "against compatibilist free will" is written in white, bold, lowercase letters, arranged in three lines.

**against
compatibilist
free will**

against
incompatibilist
free will

1. Isabel is responsible for poisoning the coffee.
2. If Isabel is responsible for poisoning the coffee, then her act of poisoning the coffee is free.
3. Isabel's act of poisoning the coffee is free.
(1,2)
4. Isabel had no choice about the chip being inserted into her brain.
5. The chip being inserted into Isabel's brain necessitates that she will poison the coffee.

- C. An act can be free even if it is necessitated by facts about which the agent has no choice.
(3,4,5)

THE FRANKFURT ARGUMENT

How about (2)? One might agree that there is a tight link between freedom and responsibility without saying that **every** act for which you are responsible is a free act. Sometimes you can be responsible for acts which are not free but which are 'downstream' from free acts of yours.

In the present case, one might say that Isabel's free actions included
“deciding on her own to poison the coffee.” **That** action was not
necessitated by the chip; so saying that it is free is no counterexample to
Necessitation/No Choice.



neccessitates that she will provide.



by facts about which the agent has no choice.

3. Isabel's act of imprisoning the confessor is free.

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Can't act can be free even if it is not at all

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We can lay out this puzzle in terms of the following master argument against the

reality of free will.



2. If Libertarianism is true, there is no free

0. There is no fire in.

1. Freewill is incompatible with determinism.



Wili.



believe in free will rejects premise (2).

Compatibility believers in free will reject premise (1). An incompatibilist

or premise (3) is true. We're now going to look at two arguments — one

for (2), and one for (3).

Now, so far we have been given no reason to think that either premise (2)



nature say that if DINS ARE happy,

4. If determinism is true, the laws of

1. No one has any choice about events which

future is not inconsistent with the state of the

of interest.

6. If $\det A$ is true, then A has any

then DECISION. (4,5)

3. If determined, the only one

choice about DECISION (2, 6, 7)

then DECISION happens. (3)

if P , then Q , then one has any choice

2. None has any choice about DIDS. ATJR.

5. No one has any choice about what the laws



happened in the distant past.

about whether @.

and none has any choice about whether,



C. If determinist is true, then no one has any

theorie about the fact that if DNR

~ If none has about choice about whether P,

varlatatie + the last of the

combination of four - that No

one has any choice about the past, no

rules out free will.

choice about the laws of nature, then no

choice principle, and determinism

This argument seems to show that the

hence that free will is incompatible with

Since the first three of these theses

seem quite plausible, the argument

seems to show that if determinism is

true, there are no free actions — and

dearminism.





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1. Freewill is incompatible with determinism.

Wili.



2. If Libertarianism is true, there is no free



Real/|the master argument:

in free will, and find the consequent argument persuasive, it looks

The consequence argument is a defense of premise (1). If you believe

tempting to reply to the master argument by denying premise (2).

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